Motor Claims Handling Manual

Version 2026.1 (UK) - effective from 01 January 2026 - reference JIG-CLM-MOTOR-2026.1

Purpose

This manual sets out how Jigsaw claims handlers manage motor claims under Jigsaw Car Insurance (wording 2026.1). It covers first notification, liability, settlement authority, total losses and fraud referral. It is for internal use only.

Service standards

Stage	Standard
First notification of loss answered	Within 60 seconds for 80% of calls
Claim acknowledged in writing	Within 1 working day
Customer contacted by the claims handler	Within 2 working days of notification
Liability decision communicated	Within 10 working days of receiving all information
Payment made after agreement of settlement	Within 5 working days

Settlement authority

Claims handlers must not agree a settlement above their authority level. The authority applies to the total amount paid on the claim, including repairs, hire and third party costs.

Role	Settlement authority
Claims handler	Up to £7,500
Senior claims handler	Up to £25,000
Team leader	Up to £50,000
Claims manager	Above £50,000, and all bodily injury claims above £25,000

First notification of loss

At first notification, record the date, time and location of the incident, the driver's details, the other vehicles and parties involved, any witnesses, any injuries, and the police reference if the police attended. Check that the driver is allowed to drive under the certificate and that the use was covered.

Validation checks

- Confirm the policy was in force on the date of the incident and the premium was paid.
- Check the telematics data for policies with endorsement M07 within 2 working days of notification.
- Check for previous claims on the vehicle and policyholder in the claims database.
- Request dashcam footage where the customer has it.

Repairs and total losses

Approved repairers

Customers should be directed to an approved repairer. The approved repairer must submit an estimate within 2 working days of receiving the vehicle. Estimates above £3,000 must be checked by an engineer before repairs are authorised.

Total loss

A vehicle is a total loss if the cost of repair is more than 60% of its market value, or if it cannot be safely repaired. Use recognised trade valuation guides and at least two comparable adverts to agree the market value. Categorise the salvage as category S (structural damage) or category N (non-structural damage) and notify the salvage agent within 3 working days.

Fraud indicators

Refer the claim to the Counter Fraud Unit before making any payment if two or more of the following indicators are present:

- the policy started or was changed within 30 days before the incident;
- the incident happened late at night with no independent witnesses;
- the customer is reluctant to provide documents or uses only a mobile phone number;
- the vehicle was recently bought for cash or has a high value compared with the customer's stated occupation;
- the third party is represented by a claims management company within 48 hours of the incident;
- injuries are reported that are not consistent with the damage to the vehicles.

Never tell the customer that the claim has been referred to the Counter Fraud Unit.

Bodily injury claims

Injury claims valued at up to £5,000 for road traffic accidents are handled through the Official Injury Claim portal. Any injury claim must be passed to the injury team within 1 working day of notification, and reserves must be set within 5 working days.

Recoveries

Where the incident was not the customer's fault, open a recovery file against the third party insurer within 10 working days. Where the third party is uninsured, apply the uninsured driver promise and refer the recovery to the Motor Insurers' Bureau.